

Christ College (Autonomous), Irinjalakuda presents

Christ-Com Quiz 2026

Semifinals · QM: Major Chandrakant Nair

(as recollected by Prayag)

Set 1

Semifinals

1.

- The Hero Honda Splendor launched in India in 1994, aimed at the middle class.
- Sales in Kerala were lukewarm at first, until demand exploded among the state’s young men in 1997.
- **Why did the Splendor suddenly find a huge new audience in Kerala that year?**

1.

It was Kunchacko Boban’s bike in Aniyathipraavu

- The 1997 Malayalam hit made the Splendor a must-have



2.

- In 1938 Benito Mussolini demanded an Italian seat on the board of a company founded in the 1860s.
- Italy objected to another European nation’s grip on it: Italian ships supplying colonies such as Italian East Africa had to pay heavy tolls to pass.
- **Which company?**

2.

The SUEZ CANAL Company

- Compagnie universelle du canal maritime de Suez, founded 1858, canal opened 1869



3.

- In 1626 the Dutch handed over goods worth 60 guilders to buy a piece of land, which they later lost to the British.
- In 2009 the Netherlands issued a €5 coin marking 400 years since the voyage that first brought them there.
- **What land did they buy?**

3.

MANHATTAN

- New Amsterdam, later New York · the 2009 coin marked Henry Hudson’s 1609 voyage



4.

- Stephen King wrote the novella *Ur* purely to promote the new version of a 21st-century gadget.
- Its hero orders one, but a glitch sends him a pink model, though the gadget only came in white.
- **Which gadget?**

4.

The Amazon KINDLE

- Ur (2009) was released for the Kindle 2



5.

- The 1886 Witwatersrand gold rush turned a small village into a city, said to be named after two surveyors who shared a first name.
- A brewery founded to slake the miners' thirst is now best known for sponsoring the country's national teams and tournaments.
- **Name the city (one word) and the beer (two words, 6 + 5).**

5.

JOHANNESBURG and CASTLE LAGER

- Castle Lager was first brewed by Charles Glass in 1895 for the miners



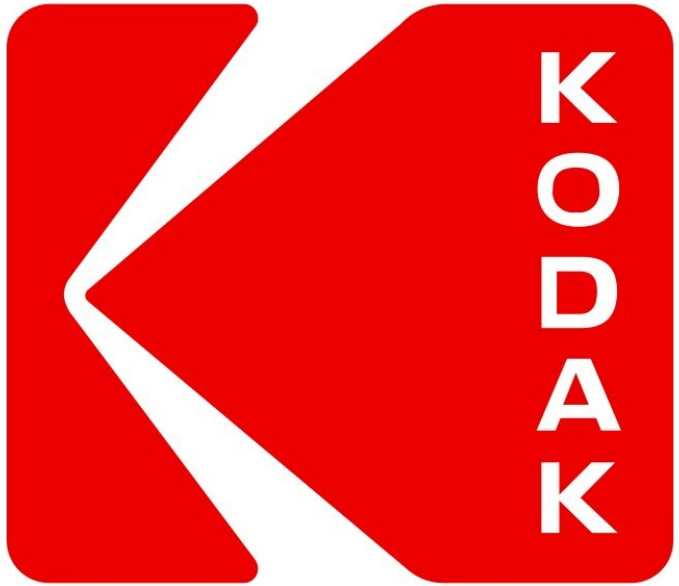
6.

- In Chapter 2 of Bram Stoker's *Dracula*, Jonathan Harker describes the estate he has bought for the Count.
- "I could not enter it, as I had not the key… but I have taken with my [BLANK] views of it from various points."
- **Which five-letter brand fills the blank?**

6.

KODAK

- Dracula (1897) uses “kodak” as a word for a camera



7.

- An airline’s tail livery shows a fluttering Union Flag.
- The design pays tribute to an event of 1805: it was based on a flag flown that day, made by Chatham’s historic flag loft.
- **Which event inspired it?**

7.

The Battle of TRAFALGAR

- British Airways' "Chatham" tailfin, based on Nelson's flag



8.

- Fannie Mae, the Federal National Mortgage Association, was set up in 1938 to expand the secondary mortgage market.
- It was born out of an economic disaster that wrecked the US housing market.
- **Name the crisis, and the two-word name for FDR’s package of measures it was part of.**

8.

The GREAT DEPRESSION · the NEW DEAL



Set 2

Written round

9.

- The 2024 edition was held in Seoul, the 2025 edition in Paris and the 2026 edition in New Delhi.
- **What are these annual events, and which UK site, famous for breaking Enigma, hosted the first one in 2023?**

9.

The global AI SAFETY SUMMITS · BLETCHLEY PARK

- Since renamed the AI Action Summit (Paris) and AI Impact Summit (New Delhi)



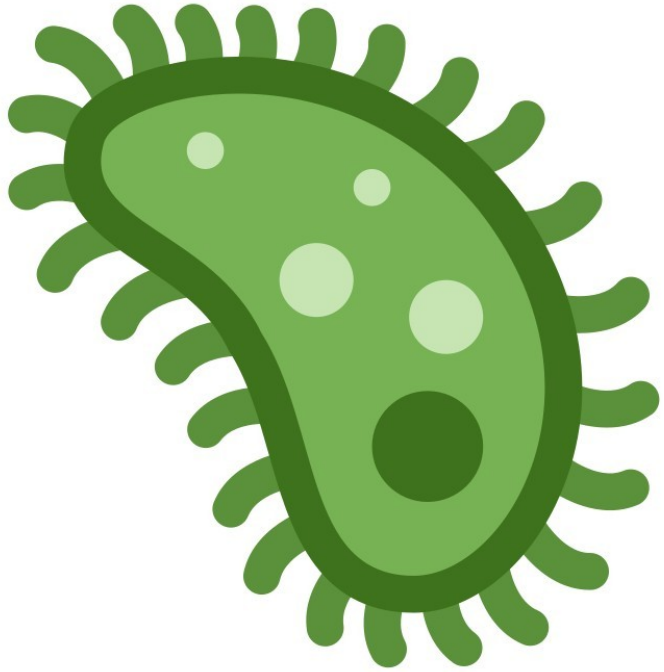
10.

- In 2026 a Dutch polar-expedition cruise ship triggered a global health alert after deaths on board.
- The virus family was first identified among UN troops during the Korean War, and is named after the river where it was found.
- **Which virus?**

10.

HANTAVIRUS

- Named after the Hantan River · the ship was Oceanwide Expeditions’ MV Hondius



11.

- A 2022 study by Approve predicted that a tech billionaire would reach a historic wealth milestone by 2024.
- **Who, and what milestone**, later expected to come with his rocket company’s stock market debut?

11.

ELON MUSK · the world's first TRILLIONAIRE

- Tied to a SpaceX IPO



12.

- In 2026 it was announced that a company’s association with a four-yearly sporting event, running since 1970, will end after 2030, with Fanatics’ Topps taking over.
- The company’s home city is also honoured by the yellow on Ferrari’s badge.
- **Name the company and the event.**

PANINI · the FIFA WORLD CUP

- Sticker albums since Mexico 1970 · yellow is Modena’s colour

FIFA

Set 3

Anti-clockwise round

13.

- In 2011 a firm set up by V.G. Siddhartha, founder of Café Coffee Day, leased vast tracts of forest abroad to supply Karnataka’s furniture makers with timbers like Greenheart and Purpleheart.

- **Which forest did the timber come from?**

The AMAZON rainforest

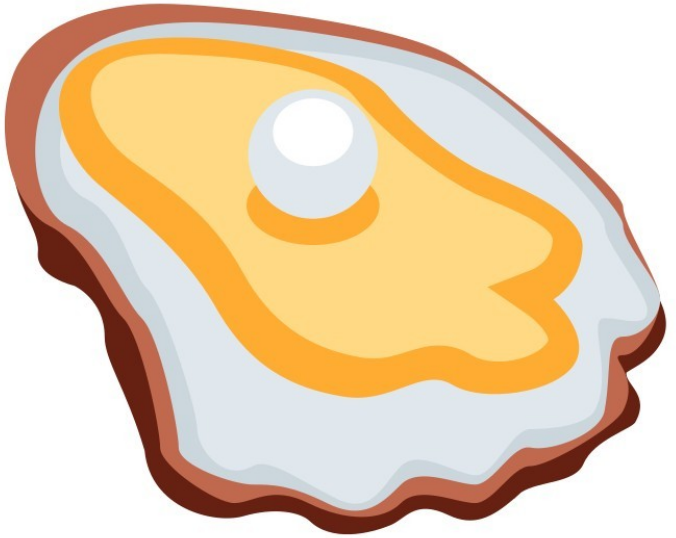
- The concessions were in Guyana



14.

- A folding design for laptops and phones protects the keys and screen when closed.
- It is named after a group of sea creatures. **What is it called?**

CLAMSHELL design



15.

- In 2015 former Red Bull marketing director Huib van Bockel teamed up with Jamling Norgay to launch an all-natural energy drink.

- It is named after Jamling’s father, who reached the top of Everest in 1953. **Name the drink.**

TENZING natural energy

- Named after Tenzing Norgay



16.

- In 1936 Oklahoma grocer Sylvan Goldman invented a device after looking at a folding chair in his office.
- In 1994 a Netscape engineer invented the browser cookie, at first to make the online version of Goldman’s idea work.
- **What did Goldman invent, and what did it become online?**

16.

The SHOPPING CART · the online “Add to Cart”

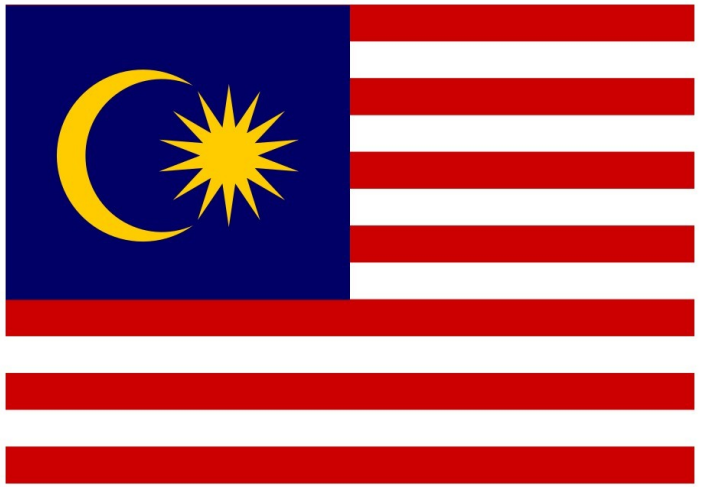


17.

- This airline’s logo is a stylised Wau Bulan, the moon kite of its country.
- In 2014 it lost two aircraft within months: MH370 and MH17.
- **Which airline?**

17.

MALAYSIA AIRLINES



18.

- In 1967 in Enfield, actor Reg Varney was photographed as the first person to use a new invention.
- Its paper vouchers contained a trace of radioactive carbon-14, which the machine detected.
- **What was it?**

18.

The ATM

- Barclays’ cash machine, the world’s first



19.

- Designed by Studio Banana, this padded hood with micro-beads lets you nap anywhere by shutting out light and noise.
- It is named after an animal famous for burying its head in the sand. **What is it called?**

19.

The OSTRICH PILLOW



20.

- In a 2012 blog post titled “Why we don’t sell ads”, the founders of a messaging service quoted Tyler Durden: “Advertising has us chasing cars and clothes...”

- **Name the service and the film.**

WHATSAPP · FIGHT CLUB

